

GLIDEPATH

T-3 Waiver Assessment

DAFMAN 13-204 Volume 2, Airfield Management
20 September 2024 (Corrective Action, 17 December 2024)

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Executive Summary

This document assesses whether Glidepath — a web-based airfield operations management application — requires any Tier-3 waivers when used as the authorized "suitable substitute" for AF Form 3616 and other DAFMAN 13-204v2 documentation requirements.

Finding: Only one T-3 waiver is required — for the CAC automated signature requirement in Paragraphs 2.5.2.10.3 and 2.5.2.10.4. All other DAFMAN requirements are either fully met by the application, addressed through manual user procedures, or outside the scope of application software.

DAFMAN Authorization for Electronic Systems

DAFMAN 13-204v2 explicitly authorizes electronic alternatives in every relevant documentation paragraph. Glidepath operates within these authorizations without requiring additional waivers:

Requirement	DAFMAN Language	Glidepath Status
AF Form 3616 (Para 2.5.2.10)	"...or suitable substitute (i.e., web-based program)"	MET — Glidepath IS the authorized substitute
AF Form 332 for discrepancies (Para 2.3.2.7.1)	"...or electronic equivalent"	MET — Discrepancies module
Airfield Lighting Chart (Para 2.3.2.6.1)	"...or electronic equivalent"	MET — Visual NAVAIDs module
Airfield Status Display (Para 4.4)	No specific form required	MET — Dashboard
Inspection Checklist (Para 5.3.2)	No specific form required	MET — Inspections module

Waiver Required

Waiver	Paragraph	Tier	Status
CAC Automated Signature	2.5.2.10.3 / 2.5.2.10.4	T-3	Draft ready (DAF Form 679)

Para 2.5.2.10.3 (T-3):

"Each AMSL/AMOS will sign the AF Form 3616, or suitable substitute, in the appropriate block at the end of his or her shift. The AMSL/AMOS signature certifies the entries are correct and the form contains all required entries."

Para 2.5.2.10.4 (T-3):

"The NAMO and either DAFM or AFM must sign after review of daily logs for trends on the airfield and/or in AM section (e.g., equipment outages and facility maintenance)."

Note to both paragraphs: "Systems that generate a CAC automated 'user signature' meets the intent of a 'signing or signature.'"

Glidepath requires individual user authentication (email/password) and records all actions with operating initials and Zulu timestamps, providing equivalent accountability. However, it does not currently integrate CAC authentication for automated digital signatures. CAC integration requires DoD identity infrastructure not available on the current commercial hosting platform. A Platform One Party Bus onboarding request has been submitted to enable CAC authentication in a future release.

A pre-drafted DAF Form 679 waiver request is available in the project documentation. T-3 waivers require Wing/CC approval per DAFMAN 90-161, Table A10.1.

Why Identified Gaps Do Not Require Waivers

The compliance matrix identifies 35 GAPS across all chapters. None of these trigger a waiver for the following reasons:

1. Procedural Items — Manual Entry Sufficient

Several AF Form 3616 annotation items (Para 2.5.2.10.5) are marked as GAPS because Glidepath does not auto-generate entries for them (e.g., personnel on airfield, SOF calls, CMAVs, weather warnings, equipment malfunctions, ARFF capability). However, users can manually enter any of these events in the Events Log at any time. The app does not prevent compliance — it simply does not automate every entry type. No format deviation means no waiver is required.

2. Training Program (Chapter 8 — 14 GAPS)

Chapter 8 requirements are for the NAMT to maintain training records, master task lists, and evaluation documentation. Until Glidepath is designated as the official training record system, these requirements are fulfilled by whatever system the unit currently uses (paper, TBA, Excel). The planned Training Management Module would serve as an "electronic training record format equivalent" once built — also without requiring a waiver.

3. External System Integrations

DAFMAN does not require all functions to reside in a single system. NOTAM Manager, AFRIMS, CE work order systems, and other external tools continue to operate independently. Glidepath supplements — not replaces — these systems. No waiver is needed for the absence of direct integrations.

4. Physical and Organizational Requirements

Requirements for staffing levels (Ch 3), facilities and equipment (Ch 4), and physical inspection conduct (vehicle with emergency equipment, etc.) cannot be fulfilled by software and are outside application scope. These are marked N/A and do not require waivers.

Compliance Summary

Category	MET	PARTIAL	GAP	N/A
Ch 1 General	1	2	0	1
Ch 2 Roles/Responsibilities	28	12	18	1
Ch 3 Staffing	0	0	1	1
Ch 4 Facilities/Equipment	1	1	0	1
Ch 5 Inspections/Checks	8	1	0	1
Ch 6 Restrictions/Closures	2	2	1	0
Ch 7 RSC/RCR	7	1	1	0
Ch 8 Training	0	0	14	0
Att 2 ACSI Checklist	104	0	0	0
Att 3 Lighting Chart	23+	0	0	0
TOTAL	174+	19	35	5

Recommended Enhancements (Not Waivers)

The following enhancements would strengthen compliance posture but are not waiver-triggering gaps. They represent opportunities to move PARTIAL items to MET:

#	Enhancement	Paragraph	Current	Effort
1	Add estimated completion date field to discrepancies	2.3.2.7.3	PARTIAL	Low
2	Add estimated resume time to runway status changes	6.2.2	GAP	Low
3	Formal Shift Sign-Off / Shift Acceptance entry types in Events Log	2.5.2.10.2 / .3	PARTIAL	Medium
4	NOTAM tracking module	2.5.2.2, 4.4, 5.3, 6.2	GAP	Medium
5	ARFF status tracking on dashboard	2.5.2.9.4, 4.4	PARTIAL	Low
6	Training Management Module	Ch 8 (14 items)	GAP	High
7	Expand auto-logged event types (CMAVs, weather, SOF, equipment)	2.5.2.10.5	GAP	Medium

Conclusion

Glidepath operates within the explicit electronic system authorizations of DAFMAN 13-204v2. The single T-3 waiver required — for CAC automated signatures on the events log (AF Form 3616 substitute) — is a temporary measure that will be resolved upon migration to DoD-hosted infrastructure via Platform One Party Bus.

All other DAFMAN requirements are either fully met by application features, addressable through standard manual procedures, or outside the scope of application software. No additional waivers are required to operationally deploy Glidepath as the primary airfield management tool.